

Palladian style

Based on Palladio's designs and theories, the Palladian style found its greatest expression in Britain during the 17th and 18th centuries, peaking in fashion during the Georgian era, c.1715–60. With emphasis on clarity, order and symmetry, Palladianism asserted the primacy of reason and the principles of classical antiquity (leading, in the work of some later architects, to a rather sterile academic formula devoid of Palladio's own forcefulness and poetry).

Palladian buildings include churches, country houses, palaces and civic buildings, usually with plain, symmetrical exteriors and richly decorated interiors. Common elements include porticoes, grand staircases, rusticated ground floors, giant Corinthian columns supporting entablatures, semicircular arches, scallop shell motifs, and pediments over exterior doors and windows. The style was established in Britain by Inigo Jones (1573–1652), William Kent (1685–1748) and Richard Boyle (1694–1753), and its legacy is apparent in neoclassical and baroque architecture.



Chiswick House London, William Kent, 1726–9